

Tweaking Ubuntu 10.10

Warning: The tweaks described below could make your Ubuntu install unstable, or cause problems. Try them at your own risk.

Enable Compiz Fusion

Compiz Fusion provides desktop effects like the 3D Cube and wobbly windows. If Compiz isn't automatically enabled on your system, you may need to install the 'official'/proprietary drivers for your graphics card. In most cases, Ubuntu detects that such 3D drivers are available (you see a circuit board icon in the system tray) and you can follow the prompts to enable the driver. If Ubuntu fails to detect it, you can manually run the Hardware Drivers tool from the System > Administration menu.

Tweaking Ubuntu made easy

Ubuntu Tweak is a nifty tool that you can install by running `sudo add-apt-repository ppa:tualatrix/ppa` to add the PPA, then search for the package in Software Centre and install it. If you can't live without Chromium, VLC and Wine, when you run `ubuntu-tweak`, sync the application centre for the first time, and you can then install the apps with just a few clicks!

System tray jazz

Jazz up your system tray with freely available indicators for apps. Ubuntu's indicator applet project aims to make panel application entries look neat—so neat, in fact, that there are hundreds of attractive and useful indicator applets available, from screenshot and system load monitoring tools, to workspace switchers and USB ejectors. Start Googling!

Unclutter Nautilus with Nautilus-elementary

Nautilus-elementary is a slimmed-down version of the default file browser. It has many great features, such as 'cover-flow'-like browsing view, a toolbar editor, a built-in terminal, the ability to hide the 'main menu', and a zoom slider. Run `sudo add-apt-repository ppa:am-monkeyd/nautilus-elementary-ppa` to add the PPA; update the package list and replace Nautilus with `sudo apt-get update && sudo apt-get dist-upgrade`.

Here comes the hot Macbuntu

Ubuntu is getting nearer to Mac-like functionality and appearance, but for those who want the whole cake now, Macbuntu is here to give you the complete look and feel. This is my favourite tweak. You can download it from <http://bit.ly/cxCGTp> or can run the following commands in a terminal:

```
wget https://downloads.sourceforge.net/project/macbuntu/macbuntu-10.10/v2.3/Macbuntu-10.10.tar.gz -O /tmp/Macbuntu-10.10.tar.gz
tar xzvf /tmp/Macbuntu-10.10.tar.gz -C /tmp
cd /tmp/Macbuntu-10.10/
./install.sh
```

After Macbuntu finishes setting everything up, restart your computer, and enjoy the new Mac OS X appearance of Ubuntu. To uninstall Macbuntu, just run the following code:

```
cd /tmp/Macbuntu-10.10/
./uninstall.sh
```

Conquer the command line the easy way

Download the cool and handy Ubuntu command reference wallpaper from <http://bit.ly/9NcLTz> and set it as your desktop wallpaper. Now looking up arcane commands is just a Show Desktop button click away!

an account right from your desktop. Open up the Ubuntu One preferences from the Me Menu and the single sign-on dialogue box will prompt you to sign up for a new account, or log in with an existing account. Fill in your email address and preferred password twice, and type the Captcha code. Your given email address will be sent as activation code, and you are good to go. Now log in with your account and press Connect, add your devices, and start syncing!

Debuting the Ubuntu font family

Another visible improvement is the new default (custom-built) Ubuntu font family, which is focused on screen

readability and also features support for the new Indian Rupee symbol, making Ubuntu 10.10 the first OS to ship with this feature. It is designed by renowned font foundry Dalton Maag.

A system tray on steroids

The improvements extend to the system tray, which is more usable compared to past releases. Now you can control (the default) Rhythmbox music player from the volume control applet, receive social networking messages, and set your online chat status right from the system tray. It also displays the temperature and weather status when connected to the Internet.